

RETURN TO TRANSYLVANIA



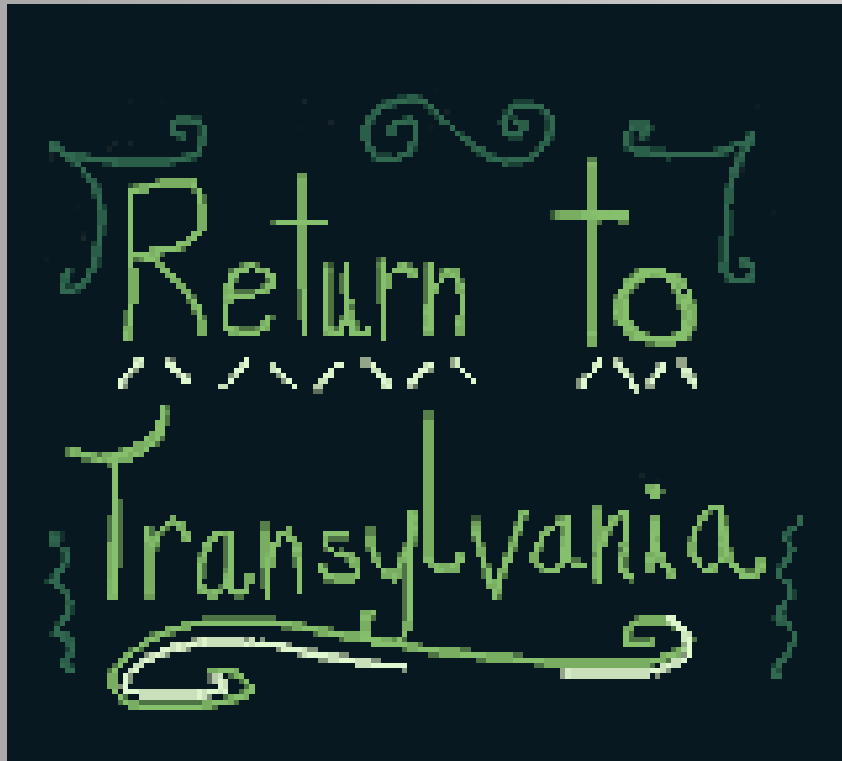


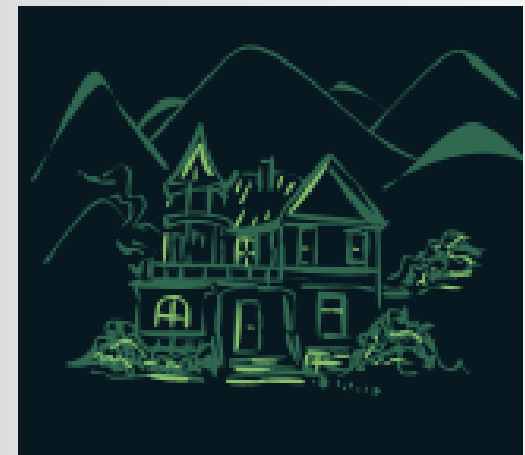
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1. Lavinia's Tale: The Story So Far

Vampire Lavinia always dreamed of life beyond the cryptic mountains of Transylvania. Sheltered by her vampire family, she longed for the pulse of city life. So, on her 18th birthday, she fled her home, stowing away on a boat bound for New York City.

But New York was not what she imagined. Hunted by sunlight and forced into the shadows, Lavinia fell into the wrong crowd. One night, after too much bloodwine and too little caution, she was caught in the sun. The authorities quickly uncovered her true nature.

Using her powers of compulsion, Lavinia avoided the stake - but only just. Her sentence: a lifetime of servitude in an Italian restaurant laced with garlic. Two months in, she's had enough. The safe in the manager's office holds the knife she needs to sever her ankle monitor. If she can escape the restaurant, navigate the bustling streets of New York, and survive the journey back home, freedom awaits.

But cars, garlic, hunters, and worse lie in her path. Help Lavinia return to Transylvania... before the city devours her for good.

2. Controls & Gameplay: How to Play

Game Genre: Adventure | Puzzle | Platformer | 2D

Engine: GB Studio

 **Controls** (Keyboard/Gamepad)

Left / Right Arrows: Move

(Up and down arrows work to move on 2D levels)

Z: Jump (on platformer levels)

Enter/Return: Skip dialogue

X: Use knife

Objectives

Escape the garlic-filled restaurant without being spotted.

Find the clues, perform the required actions, and unlock the safe to get the knife to cut off Lavinia's ankle monitor.

Do not get caught by the chef on your way out!

Cross busy streets and avoid getting hit by cars.

Use bat form to cross the ocean; make sure to avoid crosses and fire!

Cross grassland, but avoid the garlic being dropped from spaceships!

Survive the final leg back to Transylvania through a final platformer combat scene and boss scene - where you reunite with the chef and need to beat him!

Core Aesthetics

Main Aesthetics: Challenge

Lavinia must avoid and go through many obstacles, such as avoiding cars and fire from heaven, to achieve the final goal of making it back to her family. This creates a sense of vigor and motivation for the player to persevere in this journey.

Minor aesthetics: Discovery and Narrative

Player is actively discovering new challenging scenes they must conquer to move on.

There is a very active and distinct story throughout this game of Vampire Lavinia trying to Return to Transylvania,

Top-down exploration (restaurant/city levels)

Platformer levels (Garlic Field/Final Combat)

Inventory puzzles (collect clues, using knife)

Items

Clues: Help you unlock the safe.

Knife: Useful for cutting off ankle monitor and defense.

3. Tips for Surviving the City and Beyond

- Don't rush. Look for every clue to open the safe.
- Watch out for the chef. Lavinia must run from him before he catches her outside.
HINT: Move up and down!
- Getting hit by cars sets you back! Try and avoid them all.
- Getting hit by garlic will set you back; their movement is based on your movement!
- Use the knife from the safe again to defeat vampire hunters and the chef in the final combat scene. Be intentional with your timing. The chef has 10 lives, but shooting consecutively won't count more than once!

4. Behind the Coffin: Inspirations, Models, and Credits

Mental Models & Vampire Lore

Return to Transylvania plays with and against classic vampire tropes. Lavinia isn't a seductive predator or aristocratic noble; she's a rebellious teen vampire trying to go home. It goes against traditional folklore by having the vampire be the victim instead of the predator. --> (continued on next page)

However, it follows some aspects of traditional folklore mental models by incorporating crosses and garlic that will kill the player. One of the levels also has vampire Lavinia turn into a bat, reflecting how vampires are known for their bat form.

Character Model Used:

Primarily based on Carmilla, for her rebellion and femininity, though reimagined as youthful and modern. Influences from Dracula (flight, hypnosis, aristocratic origin) and Van Helsing (in enemy design: hunters, garlic weapons).

Modern Vampire Type:

Sympathetic: Lavinia is not monstrous; she is misunderstood, marginalized, and yearning for connection.



Dev Team

Lead Developers, Designers, Writers, and Artists:
Hannah Palmer, Elizabeth Recktenwald, Christopher Asuncion, and Haley Fitch

Engine: GB Studio

Fonts: GB studio default

Sound FX & Music: Pre-set in GB studio from sample game.

Special thanks to: Professor Sherrif, Professor Stepainc, and the playtesters.



Art Assets

All original character sprites and backgrounds made by Hannah Palmer and Elizabeth Recktenwald.

Tilesets to create backgrounds are from:

- <https://gumpyfunction.itch.io/game-boy-platformer-asset-pack-11-tile-sets>
- <https://horstenvault.itch.io/park-tile-set>
- <https://gumpyfunction.itch.io/game-boy-rpg-fantasy-tileset-free>
- <https://the-pixel-nook.itch.io/gb-studio-indoors>
- <https://the-pixel-nook.itch.io/gb-studio-indoor-platformer-tiles>
- <https://gamechangermods.itch.io/sunny-background-for-gb-studio>

For drawing Sprites, LibreSprite (software) was used.

Cover illustration generated with AI assistance from ChatGPT-4o (April 2025).